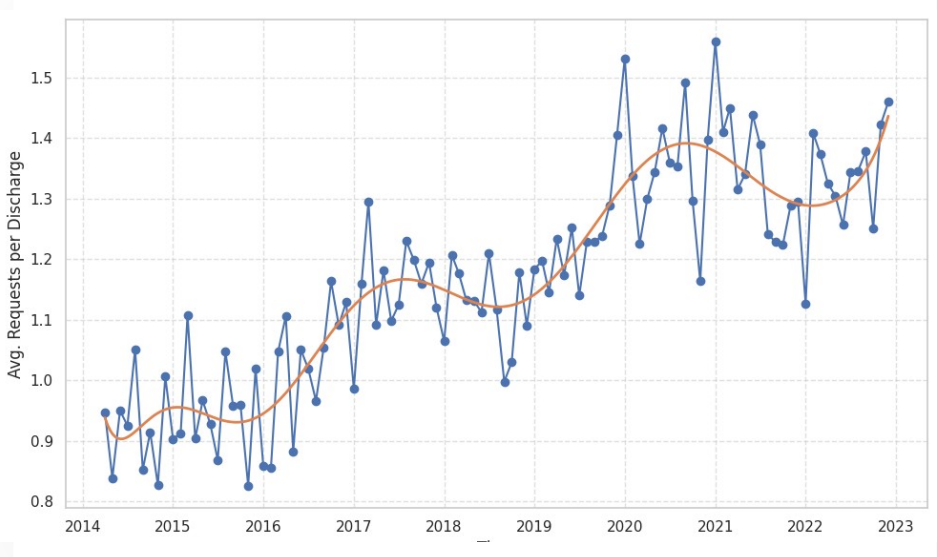
GPs are being asked to do 52% more after hospital discharge

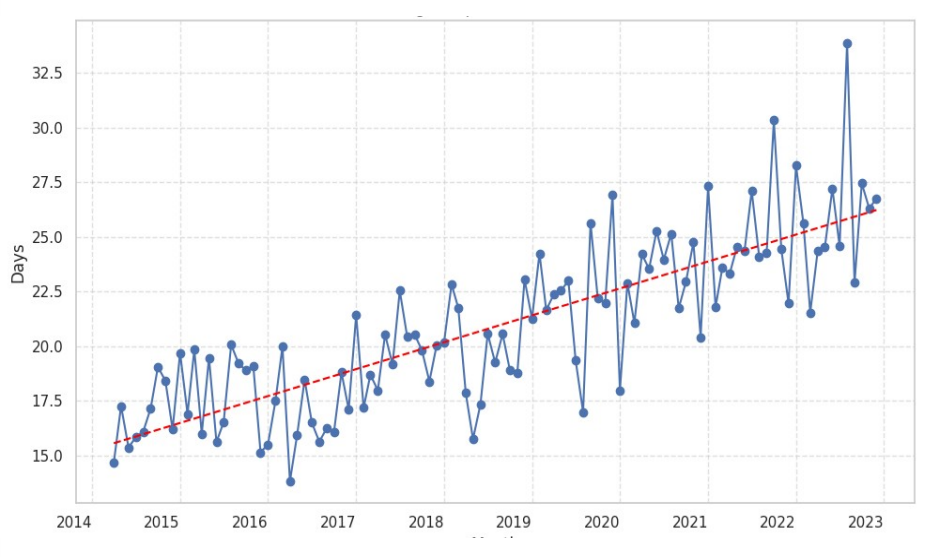
Temporal patterns in clinician discharge requests: Insights from large language model extraction

Background: Effective communication is critical for patient safety during the transition from hospital to home. We use AI to analyse trends in requests directed to GPs within 260,000 discharge summaries from Salford Royal Hospital, quantifying how these requests have changed over 10 years.

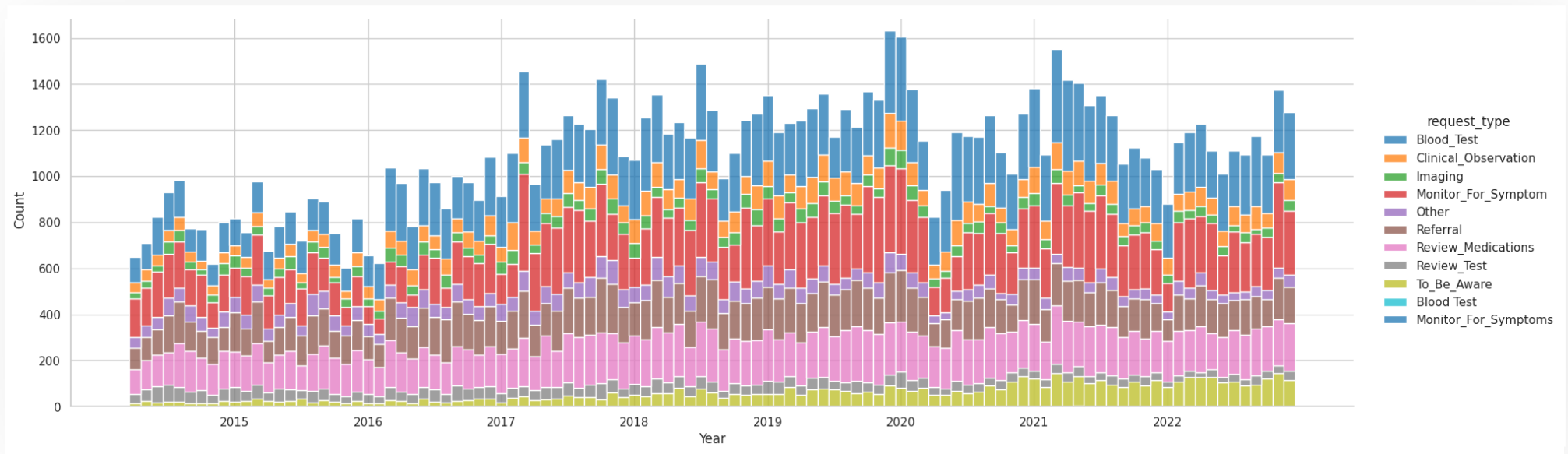
Result 1: Discharges contain 52% more requests



Result 2: GPs are given requests which take longer



Result 3: Request types have changed. More “To be aware”, fewer requests for GPs to review hospital tests



Methods

Prompt LLM to extract requests from discharge letters:

“Thankyou for your continued care. Please check U+Es in 1-2 weeks. Ramipril was held due to stage 2 AKI. Review in a month.”



Type	Timeframe
Blood Test	1-2 weeks
Medication Review	1 month

Conclusion: Rising request volumes and longer timeframes indicate growing post-discharge complexity and system strain. Increased informational messaging may add to GP workload without matching resources. These findings evidence workload transfer across the primary-secondary care interface and support aligning commissioning and discharge policy with demand.

G. Thomas Hudson, Benjamin D James, Matthew Watson, Olivier Gaillemin, Mark Holland, Darren Green, Noura Al Moubayed

Durham University · NHS Northern Care Alliance NHS Foundation Trust · Manchester 1824 The University of Manchester · University of Greater Manchester